Lesson 23

THE CHRISTIAN HOME

Aim: To present clearly God's design for the home.

Introduction:

The Christian church cannot flourish without the Christian home- the backbone of the nation, the salt of civilization.

A young doctor, his wife and three children couldn't find a house to live in so they had to stay in a hotel. A friend said to the six- year old girl, "Too bad you have no home." "Oh, yes we have a home," she replied promptly," "but no house to put in."

I. GOD-FEARING FATHERS

1. God has placed the husband as the head of the home.

Ephesians 5:23

23 For the husband is the head of the wife as Christ is the head of the church, his body, of which he is the Savior.

Abraham commanded his household which included the wife, children And servants . This is God's order and the home that reverses it, breaks God's plan destroy the peace in the home.

2. It is the husband's duty to love his wife.

Ephesians 5:25

25 Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her- Loving in health, in sickness, in poverty and in prosperity.

3. Fathers must provide to their family.

1 Timothy 5:8

8 If anyone does not provide for his relatives, and especially for his immediate family, he has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever.

4. The husband is the priest of the whole family and is responsible to establish a family altar (set a family devotion).

Job offered for the whole family.

Job 1:5

5 When a period of feasting had run its course, Job would send and have them purified. Early in the morning he would sacrifice a burnt offering for each of them, thinking, "Perhaps my children have sinned and cursed God in their hearts." This was Job's regular custom.

II. GOD-FEARING MOTHERS

Almost all great men have been made by one or two loving women - a godly mother or a devoted wife.

1. Good wives and good mothers are wonderful gifts from the Lord.

Proverbs 19:14

14 Houses and wealth are inherited from parents, but a prudent wife is from the Lord.

Prudent - wise or judicious in practical affairs;

- careful in providing for the future; provident: a prudent decision.

They become a tremendous blessing to their husbands and families.

Proverbs 31:10-12

> *10 A wife of noble character who can find? She is worth far more than rubies. 11 Her husband has full confidence in her and lacks nothing of value. 12 She brings him good, not harm, all the days of her life.*

2. The Wife's duty is to submit to their husband.

Ephesians 5:22

> *22 Wives, submit to your husbands as to the Lord. 24 Now as the church submits to Christ, so also wives should submit to their husbands in everything.*

1 Peter 3:6.

> *6 like Sarah, who obeyed Abraham and called him her master. You are her daughters if you do what is right and do not give way to fear.*

The reason for this is given in:

1 Timothy 2:11-15

> *11 A woman should learn in quietness and full submission. 12 I do not permit a woman to teach or to have authority over a man; she must be silent. 13 For Adam was formed first, then Eve 14 And Adam was not the one deceived; it was the woman who was*

deceived and became a sinner. 15 But women will be saved through childbearing-if they continue in faith, love and holiness with propriety.

3. The Wife's duty is to love the husband and the children.

Titus 2:4

3 Likewise, teach the older women to be reverent in the way they live , not to be slanderers or addicted to much wine, but to teach what is good. 4 Then they can train the younger women to love their husbands and children, 5 to be self-controlled and pure, to be busy at home, to be kind, and to be subject to their husbands, so that no-one will malign the word of God.

III. GOD-FEARING CHILDREN

1. Children are precious heritage from the Lord.

Psalm 127:3

3 Sons are a heritage from the Lord, children a reward from him.

2. Children must be brought to the Lord at an early stage.

Matthew 19:13-14

13 Then little children were brought to Jesus for him to place his hands on them and pray for them. But the

disciples rebuked those who brought them. 14 Jesus said, "Let the little children come to me, and do not hinder them, for the kingdom of heaven belongs to such as these."

3. Children must be trained

Proverbs 22:6

6 Train a child in the way he should go, and when he is old he will not turn from it.

4. Children must obey the parents.

Ephesians 6:1

1 Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is right.

CONCLUSION

The home is the greatest construction. Only a Christian Home displays a complete fulfillment of God's plan of matrimony. A family that desires to establish a truly “Christian Home" should learn to submit to God's blue- print as contained in His word.